

YOUR WEEKLY MICROSOFT SENTINEL BRIEFING

Sentinel Weekly

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A quiet week in Sentinel, and ten hard deadlines already sitting on your calendar.

NEW EVERY THURSDAY • CURATED BY PHILLIPE CHAVES DE LIMA

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Microsoft shipped nothing new for Sentinel, Defender XDR or Security Copilot between August 13 and August 19. Rather than pad this edition with last week's stories, here is the slow week version: every dated retirement that is already on your calendar, and how much time you actually have left.

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On the radar this week

- **[Microsoft Sentinel in the Azure portal retires on March 31, 2027](#)** (*Microsoft Learn*): The docs now read "After March 31, 2027, Microsoft Sentinel will no longer be supported in the Azure portal and will be available only in the Microsoft Defender portal." That is a nine month extension of the original July 2026 date. If you parked your portal migration when the date first moved, this is the version to plan against, and the good news buried in the same page is that Sentinel is generally available in the Defender portal even without Defender XDR or an E5 licence.
- **[The legacy advanced hunting API stops returning data on February 1, 2027](#)** (*Microsoft Learn*): The old `api.security.microsoft.com/api/advancedhunting/run` and `api.securitycenter.microsoft.com/api/advancedqueries/run` endpoints are retired and will stop returning data on that date. This is the quietest big break in the list, because it does not show up in a portal anywhere. It shows up in whatever Logic App, Function, Power Automate flow or homegrown script your team wrote two years ago and has not touched since.
- **[Passkeys become the default sign in experience on September 1, 2026](#)** (*Microsoft Learn*): Twelve days out. Users enabled for SMS or voice get automatically enabled for passkeys and nudged to register at MFA sign in. Microsoft provided SMS and voice delivery is then retired entirely on February 1, 2027, with

no opt out. From that date, users whose only method is SMS or voice get a blocking passkey registration prompt during sign in.

- [The Azure Monitor HTTP Data Collector API retires on September 14, 2026](#) (*Microsoft Learn*): Four weeks out, and this one is load bearing for a lot of Sentinel ingestion. Anything still POSTing custom logs through the old Data Collector API needs to be on the Logs Ingestion API with a data collection rule. Worth noting that the Sentinel SAP containerized data connector agent sits on top of this same API, which is why its own cutoff lands in the same week.
- [Why Active Directory alone is no longer enough](#) (*Microsoft Entra Blog*): Published August 13, and one of the very few Microsoft security posts that landed inside this week's window at all. Five signs your organisation has outgrown on premises AD, plus a modernisation path. Not a product announcement, but a decent framing document if you are the person who has to explain to leadership why identity work keeps landing on the SOC backlog.

In this edition

Shipped and live now

Nothing, and that is the honest headline. Across the Microsoft Sentinel Blog, the Microsoft Defender XDR Blog, the Security Copilot Blog and the what's new pages on Microsoft Learn, no Sentinel, Defender XDR or Security Copilot feature announcement carries a date between August 13 and August 19, 2026.

The last item before the window was the Sentinel Connector Builder Agent on August 11. The next thing you should expect is the September monthly roundup. If you want to keep an eye on it yourself between editions, [what's new in Microsoft Sentinel](#) on Learn is the canonical index and it updates ahead of the blog.

One thing did land inside the window that is worth ninety seconds of your time if you run endpoint hardening: the [security review for Microsoft Edge version 150](#) (*Microsoft Security Baselines Blog*), published August 13. The conclusion is that no additional settings need to be enforced, which means the useful action is to note it and move on rather than open a baseline review ticket.

Agentic SOC watch

A quiet week here too, and worth saying plainly rather than inventing momentum. The Security Copilot Blog has not published since March. On the Sentinel MCP server, Learn is still clear that the [triage and custom tool collections are in preview](#), with no GA date documented.

If you are budgeting for agentic work, the piece that is actually pinned down is the money. The [MCP server pricing page](#) documents that the MCP interface itself is offered at no extra cost in the data lake tier, and that triage tools are also at no extra cost, while KQL tool invocations bill against your data lake query meter and the entity analyzer bills SCUs. That distinction between free interface and metered tool calls is the thing most pilots get wrong in their first month.

Next door: Defender XDR and Entra

Three items your identity and endpoint neighbours are about to hand you.

[Microsoft Entra Connect Sync stops working on September 30, 2026](#) (*Microsoft Learn*) for anyone below version 2.5.79.0. Not degraded, not warned: all synchronisation services fail until you upgrade. From a SOC perspective the interesting part is the detection gap that follows, because a stalled sync means stale group membership, stale account state and stale disable actions flowing into your conditional access and your Sentinel identity entities.

[The legacy Microsoft Graph security alerts API is retiring](#) (*Microsoft Learn*), and here Microsoft's own docs disagree with themselves. The API overview says October 15, 2026. The [alerts v1 to v2 migration guide](#) says the legacy `/security/alerts` endpoint stops returning data after August 31, 2026. Plan against the earlier date, treat the later one as your outside bound, and move to `/security/alerts_v2`.

[Defender for Cloud Apps file policies retire on January 6, 2027](#) (*Microsoft Learn*). File based data protection moves to Microsoft Purview, and existing file policies need to be recreated as Purview DLP or auto labelling policies before that date. They do not migrate themselves.

The clock to watch

The whole point of a slow week. Sorted by how soon it hurts.

DATE	WHAT HAPPENS
September 1, 2026	Passkeys become the default in Entra ID. SMS and voice users are auto enabled and nudged. A temporary opt out exists for the September 1 to February 1 window via the Graph beta authentication methods policy, but not beyond it.
September 14, 2026	Azure Monitor HTTP Data Collector API retires. Move custom log ingestion to the Logs Ingestion API.
September 14 to 30, 2026	Sentinel SAP containerized data connector agent. The deployment pages say permanently disabled by September 14, the what's new page says out of support by September 30. Treat September 14 as the technical cutoff, because it is tied to the Data Collector API retirement above.
September 30, 2026	Entra Connect Sync below version 2.5.79.0 stops synchronising entirely.
October 1, 2026	Exchange Web Services disablement begins in Exchange Online. Full retirement follows on April 1, 2027.
October 15, 2026	Legacy Graph <code>/security/alerts</code> API retires, with the migration guide pointing at August 31 as the real data cutoff.
October 30, 2026	Customer managed telecom providers for SMS and voice become selectable through the Microsoft Security Store, for tenants with a regulatory reason to keep them.
January 6, 2027	Defender for Cloud Apps file policies retire. Rebuild as Purview DLP or auto labelling.
February 1, 2027	Microsoft provided SMS and voice retire in Entra ID, with a blocking passkey prompt for affected users. Legacy Defender advanced hunting API endpoints stop returning data the same day.
March 31, 2027	Microsoft Sentinel is no longer supported in the Azure portal. Defender portal only.

Two of those are inside four weeks. If you only action one thing from this edition, make it the September 14 ingestion cutoff, because it is the one that fails silently and takes your detections down with it.

One query to steal

September 1 is twelve days out, so the useful question this week is which of your users are still leaning on SMS or voice for MFA. This finds them from your Entra sign in logs, ranked by how much they depend on it.

```
// illustrative, validate in your workspace first
let retiring = dynamic(["Text message","SMS","Voice call","Phone call"]);
let strong = dynamic(["Passkey","FIDO2","Windows Hello","Certificate"]);
SigninLogs
| where TimeGenerated > ago(30d)
| where ResultType == 0
| mv-expand AuthDetail = todynamic(AuthenticationDetails)
| extend Method = toString(AuthDetail.authenticationMethod)
| where isnotempty(Method)
| summarize Signins = count(),
              LastSeen = max(TimeGenerated),
              Methods = make_set(Method, 15),
              Apps = make_set(AppDisplayName, 10)
  by UserPrincipalName
| where Methods has_any (retiring)
| extend HasStrong = Methods has_any (strong)
| where not(HasStrong)
| order by Signins desc
```

Two deliberate choices in there. The filter only catches SMS and voice, the methods actually retiring on September 1, not Authenticator push, which is staying. And it aggregates per user first, then keeps only the people whose method set has no passkey, FIDO2 or Windows Hello fallback, so you get the users who genuinely have nothing stronger rather than every user who ever received one text. Field names in `AuthenticationDetails` vary by tenant and by method, so check what your own workspace emits, and treat the authentication methods registration report as the source of truth over sign in logs.

That's Edition 4

A quiet week, and I would rather tell you that than recycle last week's news. If your calendar has a Microsoft security deadline on it that I missed, drop it in the comments and I will pull it into next week's clock.

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